

Unit 6 assessment

Unit summary

Continuous professional development is the ongoing process by which a professional maintains and extends the knowledge, judgement and skill the work requires. It is not a training course, a qualification or an appraisal requirement: it is driven by the practitioner, continuous, and measured by changed practice rather than attendance. It is obligatory because the knowledge base changes, the pupils change, initial preparation cannot be complete by construction, and the alternative to examined practice is drift toward convenience rather than stability.

Development that changes practice is sustained, embedded in the teacher's own classroom, focused on specific content and pupils, collaborative, supported by feedback on real practice, and chosen rather than assigned. Most available provision violates all six at once.

A career passes through three stages. Preservice ends when responsibility transfers; its difficulty is that everything is new at once and it needs structured practice with feedback. The new teacher stage begins abruptly with full responsibility; its difficulty is survival and it needs a mentor, reduced load and help with what is actually blocking the teacher. The experienced stage is longest and least served: attention is free so capacity is highest, while external pressure is lowest, which is where drift operates. At every stage the support offered tends to mismatch the support needed.

Five routes are suited to different things. Conferences buy exposure at the highest cost per teacher; workshops transmit a technique and cannot produce the practice, though a participant can supply the missing principles; online platforms buy reach with mixed evidence and cannot observe you; professional learning communities satisfy more principles than any other route and cost only protected time; reflective tools range from journals to lesson study, where observers watch the pupils rather than the teacher.

A plan is one page with six blocks: the gap, the evidence for it, one goal, the activity, the evidence of change, and a review date. Four things destroy a plan:

too many goals, no time made, no evidence decided in advance, and no review. At the review, continuing, narrowing or replacing the goal are all legitimate; quiet abandonment is not.

Summative assessment

Multiple-choice questions (MCQs)

1. Continuing professional development differs from a training course chiefly in that development is: (*Understand*)
 - a) driven by the practitioner, continuous, and measured by changed practice
 - b) certified by an external body
 - c) longer
 - d) required by an employer
2. Eleven attendance certificates and no change in teaching demonstrate: (*Apply*)
 - a) that the teacher needs a qualification
 - b) a lazy teacher
 - c) that the workshops were on the wrong subject
 - d) that evaluation stopped at attendance rather than reaching changed practice
3. "The alternative to development is not stability but drift" means that unexamined practice: (*Understand*)
 - a) stays the same indefinitely
 - b) improves automatically with experience
 - c) slowly adapts toward convenience without anyone deciding
 - d) becomes more demanding over time
4. A workshop lasts a single day. Which principle does that one fact directly violate? (*Remember*)

- a) chosen rather than assigned
- b) sustained over time
- c) collaborative
- d) supported by feedback on real practice

5. The new teacher transition is described as unusually abrupt because a new teacher: (*Understand*)

- a) is not permitted to ask for help
- b) has less subject knowledge than a trainee
- c) frequently carries the same load as a colleague of twenty years from the first week
- d) has no qualification

6. The experienced teacher stage is the least served because: (*Analyze*)

- a) capacity for development is highest while external pressure toward it is lowest
- b) no suitable provision exists anywhere
- c) experienced teachers refuse development
- d) experienced teachers have finished learning

7. Which route satisfies the largest number of the six principles? (*Remember*)

- a) a conference
- b) a workshop
- c) an online platform
- d) a professional learning community

8. In lesson study, observers watch the pupils rather than the teacher chiefly because it: (*Apply*)

- a) is easier
- b) removes defensiveness and directs attention to what a teacher cannot see while teaching
- c) avoids the need for planning
- d) produces a record for appraisal

9. The single most common reason a development plan fails is: *(Remember)*

- a) the school did not approve it
- b) the goal was too difficult
- c) there were too many goals
- d) the teacher changed schools

10. At a mid-year review, narrowing the goal is best understood as:
(Understand)

- a) a legitimate outcome and the commonest one
- b) grounds for abandoning the plan
- c) evidence the plan was written badly
- d) a failure of ambition

Restricted-response questions (RRQs)

1. Distinguish continuing professional development from a training course, a qualification and an appraisal requirement, by what each is for and who drives it. *(Understand)*
2. Give four reasons continuing development is obligatory rather than optional, and explain the drift argument in your own words. *(Understand)*
3. Name the six principles of development that changes practice, and state what any three of them rule out. *(Remember)*
4. Name the three career stages and state what changes at each transition. *(Remember)*
5. Sana and Imran both know about wait time and neither uses it. Explain why, and show that the reasons differ by stage. *(Analyze)*
6. Explain why capacity for development and pressure toward it are inversely arranged in the experienced stage, and what follows for how that stage must be served. *(Analyze)*
7. Give the three things a participant can do to convert a workshop into development, naming the principle each supplies. *(Apply)*

8. State what the review of technology for teacher development in low- and middle-income countries reports, and name two constraints on online platforms in Pakistani conditions. (*Understand*)
9. Name the six blocks of a one-page development plan and state what each one prevents. (*Remember*)
10. Explain why a plan written for an appraiser will be useless, referring to the separation of development from judgement. (*Analyze*)

Extended-response questions (ERQs)

1. Mr Naeem has eleven certificates and no change in practice. Diagnose why against the six principles, separate the provider's failures from his own, and design one activity that a real Pakistani government school could support. (*Create*)
2. A district has budget for one professional development intervention, for all teachers, once a year. Using the three stages, argue what it should spend it on and answer the objection from whichever group you do not serve. (*Evaluate*)
3. A head teacher has twelve teachers and a small budget. Compare at least three routes on cost, reach and the six principles, make a recommendation, state what is given up, and specify how the arrangement is protected from what ordinarily destroys it. (*Evaluate*)
4. In September, Miss Hina writes a plan with six goals: improve her questioning, integrate technology, develop better assessment practices, build stronger parent relationships, read more widely in her subject, and attend a conference. By March she has done none of it. Critique her plan against the six blocks of a one-page plan and the principles of Topic 6.1, and rewrite it as a plan that could survive a year. Your rewrite must name what evidence you would look at in March, and say why you chose the goal you kept. (*Analyze*)
5. **Integrative, and the closing task of the course.** Write your own one-page professional development plan and defend it. Justify each block: why this gap and what evidence establishes it, why one goal, why this activity

given what it can actually deliver, what evidence you will collect and why it could show you were wrong, and where the time comes from. Draw on at least three earlier units of this course, and finish by naming the plan's own weakest point. *(Create)*

Answers and marking guidance

MCQ answer key

1. **a** - all three features together; length alone does not distinguish it.
2. **d** - the certificates are an accurate record of attendance and evaluation never reached practice.
3. **c** - drift is unchosen adaptation toward convenience, which is why it is invisible from inside.
4. **b** - one day is the direct contradiction of sustained over time. Whether a workshop is also unchosen, solitary or unsupported by feedback depends on facts the stem does not give.
5. **c** - the abruptness is about load and accountability, not knowledge.
6. **a** - the inverse arrangement of capacity and pressure is the topic's analytical claim.
7. **d** - sustained, embedded, focused, collaborative and capable of supplying feedback.
8. **b** - the rule removes judgement of the teacher and directs attention to the pupils.
9. **c** - too many goals; Miss Hina's six.
10. **a** - narrowing means the goal met reality, which is the plan working.

RRQ model answers and mark schemes

1. (8 marks) Two marks per instrument: what it is for and who drives it.
Development: maintaining and extending capability, driven by the practitioner.
Course: an event, driven by a provider. Qualification: certifying a past threshold, driven by an awarding body. Appraisal requirement: an employer obligation, driven by the employer.

2. (6 marks) Knowledge base changes (1); pupils change (1); initial preparation cannot be complete by construction (1); drift (1); drift explained as unchosen adaptation toward convenience (2).

3. (9 marks) Six principles named (6); three "rules out" statements (3).

4. (6 marks) Preservice, new teacher, experienced (3); transitions: responsibility transfers; mechanics become automatic and attention is freed (3).

5. (5 marks) Sana's attention is consumed by mechanics, so there is no spare capacity (2); Imran's block is a class he cannot yet hold, not knowledge (2); concludes that identical knowledge gaps can have different stage-specific causes (1).

6. (5 marks) Mechanics automatic so attention is free, giving highest capacity (2); nothing external requires change, giving lowest pressure (2); therefore development at this stage must be self-driven or it does not occur (1).

7. (6 marks) Decide before leaving which single thing you will try (1, and with the fortnight comparison below it supplies **sustained**); agree with one colleague who attended that you will each try it and compare in a fortnight (2, supplies **collaborative**); decide what you will look at to know whether it worked (2, supplies **feedback-supported**); one mark for correctly pairing principles to actions. Award the pairing mark for any answer matching topic-03's three principles, which are the ones the workshop format lacks.

8. (5 marks) Limited, often unsustained provision, not always research-informed; real potential to extend formal and peer learning; outcomes mixed (3); two constraints from data cost, device access, electricity, connectivity (2).

9. (12 marks) Six blocks named (6); what each prevents (6): vagueness, a list of virtues, dilution across many goals, an unchosen activity, a March with nothing to look at, quiet abandonment.

10. (4 marks) A plan feeding judgement is written to look good (1); honest gaps disappear (1); Unit 4's mixed-purpose degradation (1); the remedy that the working document is the teacher's own and a summary can be supplied (1).

ERQ rubrics

Each ERQ is marked out of 20 across four criteria. A response not reaching "Adequate" on the analysis, evaluation or creation criterion cannot exceed 10 overall.

ERQ 1 - Mr Naeem's eleven certificates

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Use of the principles	Two or three applied	All six applied	Applied to the actual provision described, not to workshops in general
Attribution	Blames the teacher	Separates provider from teacher	Identifies what he could have supplied himself without permission
Design (Create)	Generic proposal	Specific activity	Startable on Monday and supplies the principles the provision violated
Constraint (Evaluate)	Assumes resources	Notes constraints	Designs within the absence of time and colleagues rather than around it

ERQ 2 - One intervention, three stages

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Use of the stages	One or two stages	All three with their needs	Needs stated specifically rather than as "more support"

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Recognition of constraint	Proposes three interventions	Accepts one	Explains what makes the choice genuinely exclusive
Defended choice (Evaluate)	Preference stated	Choice with reasons	States the criterion and answers the group not served
Realism	Not deliverable	Deliverable	Deliverable once a year on a district budget

ERQ 3 - The head's twelve teachers

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Comparison	One route	Three routes on some criteria	Three or more on cost, reach and principles
What is given up	Not stated	Stated	Stated precisely, including who loses
Protection (Create)	None	General intent	Concrete defences against the three named failure modes
Constraint (Evaluate)	Assumes protected time	Notes the difficulty	Argues whether a head in an understaffed school can actually defend it

ERQ 4 - Miss Hina's six goals, critiqued and rewritten

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Diagnosis	Says six is too many	Names the one-goal rule	Explains why six goals defeat a plan before March, not merely that they do
Against the six blocks	Names one or two missing blocks	Names the missing blocks	Identifies that the gap and its evidence were never stated, so nothing could be reviewed
Critique against the principles (Analyze)	Asserts the plan is weak	Applies the principles of Topic 6.1	Shows which principles the plan could not have satisfied, and why that follows from its structure
The rewrite	One goal, no evidence	One goal with evidence named	Evidence chosen in September that could be compared in March, with the choice of goal justified

ERQ 5 - Your own plan, defended (integrative)

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
The plan itself	Blocks missing	All six present	The gap is stated so an observer could confirm or disconfirm it

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Fit of the activity	Chosen by preference	Justified	Justified against what that route can actually deliver
Evidence design (Create)	Vague or retrospective	Decided in advance	Capable of showing the goal was not met, and the candidate says so
Use of the course and self-diagnosis (Evaluate)	No earlier units used	Draws on three units	Uses them substantively and names the plan's own weakest point honestly

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

Give feedback